

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ -

♦ K Q J 3

♣ J 8 3

♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 9

♣ K 9 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 2

♥ K 8 3

♦ 10 8 5 4

♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ K 6 3

♥ A 10 5

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ A 7 5

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

♥K. But if East does have the ♥K it will do you no good to ruff West's ♠A, East will over-ruff and you would still have that ♣ loser.

So do it this way instead. Discard the ♣ loser on West's ♠A! Another ♠ from West won't hurt you since dummy would be able to over-ruff East. Whatever West plays you can win, then finesse East out of his ♥K.

It was said earlier that you didn't have a winner on which you could discard the ♣ loser.

That was true, so instead you were able to discard it on a loser!

You would really like to have a transfer bid in this situation, to make South bid ♥s.

But you don't have one, so you just bid 4 ♥ yourself.

North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♠10. You play low in dummy and East holds the trick. He continues the suit and West takes the ♠Q and then plays the ♠A.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

You've already lost the 2 ♠s. If East has the ♥K you might avoid a loser there. You don't have a winner on which to discard the ♣ loser.

If West has the ♥K it will have to be a singleton to help you, so it is more logical to play East for the

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Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5 3

♥ Q 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 5 4 2

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ K 7 4

♦ 10 7 3

♣ Q J 3



♠ A Q J 10

♥ A 6 5

♦ A Q 8 5

♣ K 10

♠ 9 2

♥ J 10 9 8 2

♦ 9 4

♣ A 9 7 6

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

North holds only two small ♠s with his ♠K, then two entries will be enough. But what if North holds ♠K x x x ? Can you find a third entry to dummy?

If the ♦s split 3-2 the answer is **YES**. Play the ♦A, then lead your ♦8 to dummy's ♦J. Watch carefully to see if both defenders follow to this trick. They do. Play a ♠ to your ♠10, which holds the trick. Play your ♦Q to dummy's ♦K. Finesse the ♠ again. Return to dummy by playing your ♦5 to dummy's ♦6, then finesse the ♠ one last time.

If the ♦s had split 4-1 you would not have been able to enter dummy three times. That would have been very unlucky.

If you played your ♦5 too early you would not have been able to enter dummy three times even when there was a 3-2 split. That would have been very unsmart.

With 20 HCP and balanced distribution you should open 2NT. Do not let the good 4-card ♠ suit sway you to anything else. Partner bids 3NT and everybody passes.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥J. You try the ♥Q, but North plays the ♥K.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 4 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more winners and at least 2 of them must come from ♠s. Furthermore you don't want North to lead ♣s through your King. Your best hope is that North holds the ♠K so you can finesse.

So you win the ♥A and start thinking about dummy entries. Your obvious entries are the ♦K and ♦J. If

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 2

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 3

♠ K J 3

♥ J 8 3

♦ 7 4

♣ J 10 9 5 4



♠ 7 6

♥ K 10 7

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ Q 7 6 2

♠ A Q 9

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ A 10 9 3

♣ A K

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South